Sanika Satoskar

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PROFILE

Data and business analyst with two years at NielsenIQ owning demand forecasts and pricing scenarios for new-product launches across 20+ global CPG brands, landing within ±9% of actuals, plus startup operating experience in a founder's office. Now pursuing an MS in Applied Data Science at the University of Chicago and building AI workflows and predictive models in Python, SQL, and PySpark.

EDUCATION

University of Chicago, MS in Applied Data Science · GPA 4.0/4.0 — Expected Dec 2027
Coursework: Statistical Models, Time Series Analysis, Machine Learning, Generative AI, Data Engineering

Sydenham College of Commerce and Economics, Mumbai: Bachelor of Management Studies (Hons) · GPA 9.52/10 · **Rank 1, Summa Cum Laude** — Apr 2024
Major: Finance & Data Analytics · Minor: Operations Research

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Data & Analytics: Python, SQL (PostgreSQL), R, PySpark, Tableau, Advanced Excel, Streamlit, AWS

Methods: Time Series Forecasting, Regression, XGBoost, A/B Testing & Experiment Design, KPI & Metric Design

AI: Generative AI, LLM Agents & Tool-Calling, Prompt Engineering, AI Workflow Automation

Business: Market & Competitor Analysis, Pricing & Promotion Analysis, SKU & Assortment Analysis, Executive Presentations

Certifications: McKinsey Forward Program, Financial Modelling Foundations, Inside LVMH Certificate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

NielsenIQ: Product Consulting & Data Analyst — Jun 2024 – Aug 2026

- Owned demand forecasts and pricing/distribution scenarios for new-product launches across 20+ global CPG brands (Reckitt, Nestlé, PepsiCo, General Mills, Henkel), turning ambiguous growth questions into testable hypotheses and a recommended launch plan for client leadership
- Tracked forecasts against actuals one year post-launch across the US and Latin America, feeding variance drivers back into model and planning assumptions to improve each next cycle
- Designed in-market tests (test-vs-control; pack, price, flavor) and quantified SKU cannibalization, benchmarking velocity and share against competitors to recommend which variant to scale
- Translated results into concise readout decks and written summaries for client brand, marketing, and leadership teams

On The Move: Founder's Office — Jan 2025 – Aug 2026

- Partnered with the founder to design and launch the end-to-end client onboarding process (intake, agreements, communication protocols) for a high-net-worth service, owning requirements, rollout, and tracking
- Managed delivery of the platform MVP as the cross-functional hub for the founder, coaches, tech partners, and clients: prioritized work and tracked milestones and acquisition and retention metrics

University of Chicago, Student Disability Services: Data & AI Solutions Intern — Oct 2026 – Present

- Mapping the inbox workflow to design and pilot an AI-assisted email triage automation, with an AI ethics and data privacy review
- Building Director-level KPI reporting templates from core case-management data fields to track performance against team goals

PROJECTS

Retail Category Analytics Pipeline (PySpark, Streamlit) — 2026

- Turned 1.07M raw retail transactions into SKU velocity, Pareto, and launch-curve tables; found 22% of SKUs drive 80% of revenue and backtested demand forecasts (seasonal-naive 17.5% WAPE beat Holt-Winters 36.9%)

Fraud Detection on Card Transactions (Python, XGBoost) — 2026

- On ~285K real transactions (0.17% fraud), caught 85% of fraud at a 0.1% false-alarm rate vs 82% for a logistic baseline (PR-AUC 0.83 vs 0.71)

Retention A/B Test: Progression Gate (Mobile Game)

- Across ~90K players, found the later gate cut 7-day retention by 4.3% (p = 0.002, bootstrap-confirmed) and recommended the lower gate

PayPal AI Hackathon: Merchant Cash-Flow Copilot — Oct 2026 – Present

- Building an AI agent on PayPal APIs that answers merchant questions on sales and fees and forecasts low-cash weeks

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

- **The BMS Society, Chairperson:** Led seminars and conferences for 500+ participants; mentored a 120-member team for Finance Conclave '23
- **Rotaract Club of Mumbai Anchors, President:** Led club strategy and operations; Presidential Citation
- **Sydenham Placement Cell, Co-Chairperson:** Coordinated campus placement drives and Career Summit '23